

Award
FINRA Dispute Resolution Services

In the Matter of the Arbitration Between:

Claimant

Raymond James & Associates, Inc.

Case Number: 25-01561

vs.

Respondent

Kevin D. Laurie

Hearing Site: New York, New York

Awards are rendered by independent arbitrators who are chosen by the parties to issue final, binding decisions. FINRA makes available an arbitration forum—pursuant to rules approved by the SEC—but has no part in deciding the award.

Nature of the Dispute: Member vs. Associated Person

REPRESENTATION OF PARTIES

For Claimant Raymond James & Associates, Inc. (“Claimant”): Todd Ratner, Esq., Ratner Law, Richmond, Virginia.

Respondent Kevin D. Laurie (“Respondent”) did not enter an appearance.

CASE INFORMATION

Statement of Claim filed on or about: July 30, 2025.

Claimant signed the Submission Agreement: July 30, 2025.

CASE SUMMARY

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant asserted a cause of action for breach of promissory note.

RELIEF REQUESTED

In the Statement of Claim, Claimant requested: rescission of the Forbearance Agreement, the First Addendum, and the Second Addendum; compensatory damages in excess of \$300,000.00 but no more than \$500,000.00; prejudgment interest at the default rate; post judgment interest at the applicable legal rate; costs of collection, including reasonable attorneys’ fees, consistent with the provisions of the Argent Loan Agreement; and additional and further relief as may be deemed just and appropriate.

OTHER ISSUES CONSIDERED AND DECIDED

The Arbitrator acknowledges having read the pleadings and other materials filed by the parties.

Respondent did not file a Statement of Answer. Accordingly, this matter proceeded pursuant to Rule 13807(e)(1) of the Code of Arbitration Procedure ("Code").

The Arbitrator determined that Respondent was served with the Claim Notification letter dated July 31, 2025 by regular mail, and the Overdue Notice (including the Statement of Claim) dated September 22, 2025 by regular mail. The Arbitrator also determined that Respondent was served with the Notification of Arbitrator dated October 20, 2025 by regular mail.

The Claim Notification letter notified Respondent that FINRA rules require parties to use the online DR Portal on a mandatory basis (except pro se investors) and that failure to register for the DR Portal will prevent the submission of pleadings, selection of arbitrators, and receipt of notification relating to case information and deadlines. Respondent failed to register for the DR Portal.

By Order dated October 21, 2025, the Arbitrator ordered Claimant to serve Respondent with its Statement of Claim and all attached exhibits by FedEx direct signature required addressed to Respondent's place of business, and to submit to FINRA proof of service immediately upon completion of said service. On October 23, 2025, Claimant provided proof of service of the Statement of Claim and attached exhibits on Respondent.

The Arbitrator determined that Respondent is, therefore, bound by the Arbitrator's ruling and determination.

AWARD

After considering the pleadings, the Arbitrator has decided and determined in full and final resolution of the issues submitted for determination as follows:

1. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$323,509.00.
2. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant interest on the above-stated sum at the rate of 6% per annum from December 24, 2024 through and including the date of entry of this Award.
3. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant interest on the above-stated sum at the applicable rate provided under the laws of the State of Florida from the date of entry of the Award until the date the Award is paid in full.
4. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant the sum of \$1.00 in attorneys' fees pursuant to the Promissory Note and Security Agreement dated October 16, 2014 and the Forbearance Agreement and Release dated April 28, 2017. Since Claimant did not submit any evidence substantiating the amount of attorneys' fees incurred, nominal attorneys' fees of \$1.00 are awarded.
5. Respondent is liable for and shall pay to Claimant \$300.00 to reimburse Claimant for the Paper Decision Fee previously paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services.
6. Any and all claims for relief not specifically addressed herein are denied.

FEES

Pursuant to the Code, Claimant has paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$2,640.00 Member Surcharge and \$5,040.00 Member Process Fee previously invoiced.

Claimant has also paid to FINRA Dispute Resolution Services the \$1,250.00 non-refundable portion of the filing fee and the \$300.00 Paper Decision Fee.

ARBITRATOR

Carol Maria Luttati

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Sole Public Arbitrator

I, the undersigned Arbitrator, do hereby affirm, pursuant to Article 7507 of the Civil Practice Law and Rules, that I am the individual described herein and who executed this instrument, which is my award.

Arbitrator's Signature

Carol Maria Luttati

Carol Maria Luttati
Sole Public Arbitrator

12/23/2025

Signature Date

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December 24, 2025

Date of Service (For FINRA Dispute Resolution Services use only)